



CONTACT

📍 Córdoba, Argentina
✉️ franco.testagrossa@gmail.com
🌐 github.com/ffakenz
🌐 in/franco-testagrossa

STACK

Languages Scala 9y · Haskell 4y · Rust 4y

Backend Akka 6y · Typelevel 6y · ZIO 4y

Cloud & infra AWS 7y · Kubernetes 7y ·
Docker 7y · Terraform 7y · GCP 2y

Data Kafka 7y · Spark 3y · Druid ·
Elasticsearch · Cassandra · DynamoDB ·
PostgreSQL

FOCUS

Payments Blockchain Integrations

Event-driven Distributed systems

AI · Claude Code / Codex

Born in Italy · raised in Argentina
Boxing · asados · music

Franco Testagrossa

COMPUTER SCIENTIST · SOFTWARE CRAFTSMAN
BLOCKCHAIN ADVOCATE · AI ENTHUSIAST

Passionate engineer, focused on **high-throughput, event-driven systems for payments and other regulated domains**. Led multi-provider payment integrations for LATAM's largest e-commerce behind a single plugin architecture. Career highlight: **core contributor to Cardano's Hydra** — the open-source layer-2 scaling protocol. Operate with domain-level ownership — driving architecture across teams, setting the reliability and quality bar, and mentoring engineers. Conference speaker and open-source maintainer.

§ EXPERIENCE

2022 — 2026

Jul — Feb

Remote

Software Engineer, Hydra Protocol · Input Output (IOHK)

Core contributor to Hydra — Cardano's open-source layer-2 protocol for fast, low-cost payments — in a research-first environment.

- Drove protocol and state-machine architecture independently, adopted across squads; co-authored major updates (incremental commit/decommit, deposit recovery with deterministic FIFO ordering).
- Guaranteed fund safety: deposits recoverable from any protocol state, plus side-loaded snapshot recovery for stuck heads — no costly on-chain settlement.
- Owned production reliability — event-log checkpointing/rotation, network fault-tolerance suites, Prometheus/Grafana observability, and same-day root-cause of a silent node hang during the Midnight GlacierDrop.
- Core maintainer of three tools (hydra-tui, chain-observer, explorer), maintained the formal specification with researchers, onboarded most of the team, and delivered IOG's "Developing Hydra" masterclass at the 2023 Cardano Summit.

STACK Haskell · Plutus · Nix · Docker · Prometheus/Grafana · event-sourcing

2020 — 2022

Sep — Jun

Marbella

Software Engineer, Analytics Platform · Valsea IT

Founding-team engineer on a multi-tenant licensed online-gaming platform — 24+ providers, 3,000+ games, 6 brands across 3 regulatory licenses (CRC, MGA, SGA).

- Led the analytics domain — metrics, audit reports and insights via a GraphQL back-office over Elasticsearch and Druid, fed from Kafka through parallel event-consumer and Spark-pipeline ingestion.
- Built a Google-Analytics-style query API translating client requests into Druid queries with post-aggregation metrics and currency conversion.

STACK aws-eks · k8s · terraform · cassandra · cats · kafka · sangria graphql · akka-http/grpc · druid · elastic4s · spark · akka-streams · rust

2019 — 2020

Nov — Aug

Barcelona

Software Engineer · Letgo

- Built the rules-engine ("brain of the platform") for a second-hand marketplace on Siddhi complex-event processing — taking a Java POC to a production Scala system with the lead architects.
- Managed k8s rules-cluster state, rule versioning and debug-mode execution; earlier contributed to the akka-cluster chat platform.

STACK aws-eks · k8s · terraform · dynamodb · cats · kafka · siddhi · aws-sqs · aws-sns

2018 — 2019

Jun — Oct

Buenos Aires

Technical Lead, Payments Platform · Tiendanube

Led the payments platform for the largest e-commerce in LATAM.

- Designed a plugin architecture where each payment-provider integration ran as its own state machine, reconciling the core payment system on every provider/system event — the reusable pattern every new integration followed.
- Integrated multiple payment providers across countries, regulations, security profiles and SLA regimes; owned system design, RICE prioritization and third-party integration governance (audits, SLAs).

STACK aws-eks · k8s · terraform · akka-cluster · mongodb · akka-persistence · kafka · cats